Ekaterina (Kate) Volkova

CONTACT INFORMATION

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ACADEMIC POSITION

Finance Department, The University of Melbourne

Associate Professor	**2024 – present**
Assistant Dean (Graduate Research)	**2025 – present**
Senior Lecturer (Assistant Professor)	**2017 – 2023**

EDUCATION

SC Johnson College of Business, Cornell University, PhD, Finance **2017**
New Economic School, MA, Economics **2012**
Moscow State University, MS, Mathematics *summa cum laude* **2011**

PUBLICATIONS

Antitrust Enforcement Increases Economic Activity, with Tania Babina, Simcha Barkai, Jessica Jeffers, and Ezra Karger
Conditionally Accepted, American Economic Journal: Applied Economics

Regulatory Fragmentation, with Joseph Kalmenovitz and Michelle Lowry
The Journal of Finance, 2025
Brattle Group Prize (Distinguished Paper); HKU Best Publication Award

Is Blockholder Diversity Detrimental? with Miriam Schwartz-Ziv
Management Science, 2025

Information Revelation Through Regulatory Process: Interactions between the SEC and Companies Ahead of the IPO, with Michelle Lowry and Roni Michaely
The Review of Financial Studies, 2020

Watch Your Basket – to Determine CEO Compensation, with Neal Galpin, Hae Won (Henny) Jung, and Lyndon Moore
Financial Management, 2019

Can VPIN Forecast Geopolitical Events? An Application to the Crimean Crisis, with Felipe Silva
Annals of Finance, 2018

REVIEW CHAPTERS

Initial Public Offering: A Synthesis of the Literature and Directions for Future Research, with Michelle Lowry and Roni Michaely
Foundation and Trends® in Finance, 2017

EVENT STUDIES

When deregulation wins: Cross-sectional evidence from the 2024 Trump election with Alan Kwan and Cagri Onuk
Finance Research Letters, 2026

Media Ownership and Ideological Slant: Evidence from Australian Newspaper Mergers, with Maxim Ananyev
PLOS One, 2024

WORKING PAPERS

Lobbying Congress versus Agencies, with Michelle Lowry
Revise and Resubmit, *The Journal of Finance*

Him Too? Analyzing the Effects of Epstein Connections, with Marina Gertsberg and Michaela Pagel
CEPR Discussion Paper 21352; CESifo Working Paper 12580

Awards & Prizes

Brattle Group Prize (Distinguished Paper) **2025**
The Journal of Finance, for "Regulatory Fragmentation"

HKU Best Publication Award in Governance and Sustainability **2026**
HKU Business School, for "Regulatory Fragmentation"

Best Paper Award, VICIF **2026**
for "Him Too? Analyzing the Effects of Epstein Connections"

Best Paper Award, Lake District Workshop in Corporate Finance **2026**
for "Lobbying Congress versus Agencies"

The Brattle Group FIRN Best Paper Award **2024**
for "Antitrust Enforcement Increases Economic Activity"

Best Paper Award, CAFM Conference **2023**
for "Regulatory Fragmentation"

Best Paper Award, FMARC Conference **2023**
for "Regulatory Fragmentation"

Cynthia Hardy Award for Research Impact, University of Melbourne **2023**

Data

Block Ownership: all blockholders holding at least 5% of US public companies, 1998–2025. Available via WRDS and my website.

Regulatory Fragmentation: firm-level Regulatory Fragmentation, Topic Dispersion, and Regulation Quantity for all US public firms, 1995–2025. Available on my website.

Rule Relatedness: company-specific rule relatedness for all proposed and final SEC rules, 1999–2023. Available on my website.

Policy Impact

Research cited in U.S. federal rulemakings
Regulatory Fragmentation: U.S. Department of the Treasury (FinCEN), Proposed Rule on AML/CFT Requirements for Investment Advisers, 90 Fed. Reg. 45361 (2025)

Information Revelation Through Regulatory Process: U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission, Special Purpose Acquisition Companies, Shell Companies, and Projections, Proposed Rule, 87 Fed. Reg. 29458 (2022)

Initial Public Offering: A Synthesis of the Literature: U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission, Solicitations of Interest Prior to a Registered Public Offering, Proposed Rule, 84 Fed. Reg. 6713 (2019), and Final Rule, 84 Fed. Reg. 53011 (2019)

Presentations & Conferences

The list includes scheduled, online and by coauthors
2027: AFA (expected); AEA (expected)
2026: Finance Down Under; 4th HKU Summer Finance Conference, Hong Kong; UEBS Edinburgh Corporate Finance; Lake District Workshop in Corporate Finance; FMA Europe, Braga, Portugal; CICF; VICIF 2026; NBER

SI Corporate Finance; NUS RMI 19th Risk Management Conference, Singapore; EFA; Australian Competition and Consumer Commission; University of Auckland; University of Queensland; Strathclyde University
2025: Finance Down Under; 7th Future of Financial Information Conference; FIRS; Erasmus Corporate Governance Conference; EFMA; Global PhD Student Colloquium; Third Aarhus Workshop on Strategic Interaction in Corporate Finance; EFA; Politics in Finance; FMA Asia; Monash University
2024: Adam Smith Workshop, London, UK; HKU Summer Finance Workshop, Hong Kong; NBER SI; FIRN Annual, Port Douglas, Australia; SBFC, Sydney Australia; Deakin University; University of Essex
2023: AFA, New Orleans; AEA New Orleans; Boston College; The Department of Justice, Antitrust Division; NBER SI; FMARC, Cyprus
2022: Financial Research Network (FIRN); Copenhagen Business School; the Federal Reserve; George Mason University; University of Rochester; University of Toronto; University of Melbourne; University of Washington; Wayne State University; Florida International University; University of Bath; University of Bristol
2021: University of Melbourne; Asia-Pacific Corporate Finance Online Workshop; FIRN Women Conference; the Future of Financial Information Conference; APRCF Conference
2020: FIRN seminar; University of Melbourne; Asia-Pacific Corporate Finance Online Workshop
2019: Summer Finance Conference, Hebrew University, Jerusalem, Israel; University of Technology, Sydney, Australia; Queensland Corporate Finance Conference, Brisbane, Australia
2018: AFA, Philadelphia; University of New South Wales, Sydney; Australian National University, Canberra; Office of the Comptroller of the Currency, Washington; Fifth Annual Conference of Financial Market Regulations at the SEC, Washington; Executive Compensation Conference in Rotterdam, Netherlands; FIRN Annual Meeting, Brisbane, Australia; FMA, San Diego, USA
2017: PFMC, Paris, France; FMA, Boston, USA; Frontiers of Finance, London, UK; Hong Kong University, Hong Kong; University of Melbourne, Melbourne, Australia; Copenhagen Business School, Copenhagen, Denmark; Michigan State University, East Lansing, MI, USA; London Business School, London, UK; New Economic School, Moscow, Russia; Higher School of Economics, Moscow, Russia; Emory University, Atlanta, GA, USA
2016: Cornell University, Ithaca, NY, USA; Binghamton University, Binghamton, NY, USA; New Economic School, Moscow, Russia; Higher School of Economics, Moscow, Russia
2015: STRATA Big Data, New York, USA
2014: Queen's University, Kingston, Canada

Policy Writing

How businesses with ties to Jeffrey Epstein saw norms and share prices suffer
The Conversation

Him Too? The Corporate Consequences of Epstein Connections
Oxford Business Law Blog

Corporate Lobbying of Executive Agencies
CLS Blue Sky Blog, Columbia Law School

Antitrust Enforcement Increases Economic Activity
ProMarket, Stigler Center, University of Chicago

The Government Agenda and the Effects of Regulatory Dispersion
The FinReg Blog, Duke University School of Law

Initial Public Offering: A Synthesis of the Literature
Oxford Business Law Blog

Media Coverage & Podcasts

Him Too?: Salon, Klement on Investing
Regulatory Fragmentation: Marginal Revolution, HKU Jockey Club ESGRI (feature and podcast), Drexel LeBow News
Lobbying Congress versus Agencies: HKU Business School
Antitrust Enforcement: The Brattle Exchange (podcast)
VPIN and the Crimean Crisis: Bloomberg, Washington Post, Radio Free Europe, Vedomosti, Der Standard, InfoMoney

Grants & Scholarships

AFAANZ Research Grant	**2026**
ARC Support Grant (DECRA Seed), FBE, University of Melbourne	**2025**
CALIBER FBE Research Lab, University of Melbourne	**2025**
ARC Support Grant (DECRA Seed), FBE, University of Melbourne	**2024**
Early Career Research Grant, University of Melbourne	**2021**
FBE Research Grant, University of Melbourne	**2021**
Early Career Research Grant, FBE, University of Melbourne	**2020**
AFAANZ Research Grant	**2020**
Student Travel Grant for AFA Annual Meeting	**2016**
Anna S. Dvornikova and Ilya A. Strebulaev Fund	**2012**
BP Scholarship	**2010–2012**
New Economic School Academic Scholarship	**2011–2012**
Moscow State University Academic Scholarship	**2006–2011**

Professional Service

Referee: The Quarterly Journal of Economics; The Review of Financial Studies; Journal of Financial and Quantitative Analysis; Review of Finance; Management Science; Review of Corporate Finance Studies; Journal of Banking and Finance; Journal of Corporate Finance; Financial Review; Journal of Regulatory Economics

PhD Supervision

Completed candidates and first placement

Phuong Lan Nguyen, University of Adelaide	**2020**
Yifan Zhou, Fudan University	**2021**
Muhan Hu, University of Strathclyde	**2023**
Sheng Huang, Jinan University	**2023**
Grace Meng, Southwestern University	**2023**
Stephen Dixon (in progress)	**expected 2026**

Workshops

Summer School in Financial Intermediation and Contracting, WashU	**2015**
Yale Summer School in Behavioral Finance	**2013**

Professional Experience

Research Fellow, Research Laboratory for Strategic Behavior and Institutional Design, Moscow	**2011 – 2012**
Research Fellow, Yandex, Moscow	**2011**

Personal Information

Married with one child (born in 2022); Australian and Russian citizenship

Last updated: October 2026